

Otters

Otters are mammals that have webbed feet to help them swim. The river otter lives along river banks and spends its day swimming to catch food.



Otters of the sea

The sea otter is the smallest sea mammal. It has luxurious, thick fur that keeps it very warm. It rarely comes to land, and even sleeps in the water. When it nods off, it wraps itself up in kelp plants to stop it from drifting away!

Sea cows

Manatees are often called sea cows because they are so big and they “graze” on underwater plants. They spend all their lives in water, and even give birth there.



Walruses

Walruses are huge sea mammals. They have powerful, blubbery bodies and two large, front teeth, called tusks, which can grow up to 1 m (3 ft) long. Their tusks help them cut through ice sheets and keep enemies away.

Walruses use their noses, like pigs, to root around the sea floor for food, such as crabs or sea urchins.



In the pink

Walruses are normally greyish brown in colour. But when they sunbathe, they turn blush-pink because their blood rushes to the surface of their skin to cool it down.